

Research: AI Policy Questions for HR

Project: AI Assistant for HR

Task: Research HR Policy Questions

Role: UX

Sprint 1 - Week 1

Deliverables: Employee question diagram, pain-point analysis, real AI examples, written findings.

Prepared by: Arman Gholami (s4039910)

Table of Contents

Title	1
Purpose and Scope	1
Current-State Process	2
Pain Point and Bottlenecks.....	3
Current uses of AI chatbots / FAQ tools answering policy questions	4
References	5

Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this research is to find the use case for using an AI chatbot/tool to find an answer to company policies. It looks at analysing how the question-asking process typically works, from how they ask a question, who they will ask, how long they'll have to wait, etc.

We will look into the typical process, analyse the pain points, and discuss real use cases of AI chatbots or FAQ tools that streamline this problem.

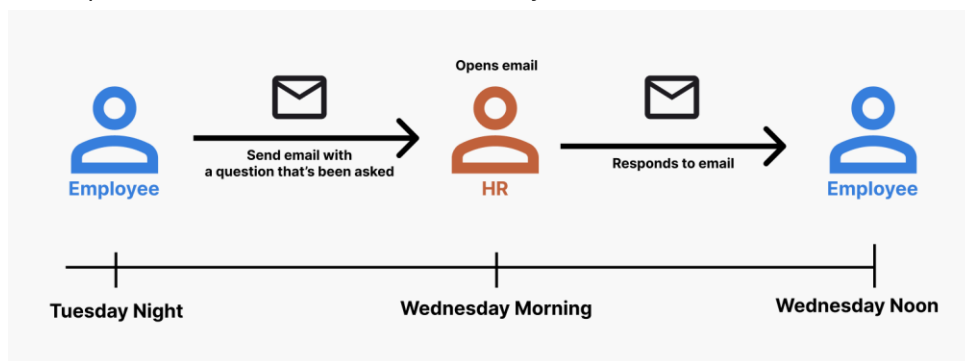
It has been stated that an AI-powered agent can “direct new hires to key resources and relevant training materials and answer common questions 24/7” (Zendesk, 2026), we will be looking into this more in depth.

Current-State Process

The typical process of a employee asking HR questions typically relies on manual searching / interactions, which results in bottlenecks.

The process is typically as demonstrated:

- Scenario 1: Repeated Questions
 1. Employee asks a question one day, a question that has an answer to in a Policy document
 2. HR opens the question the next day, a question which has been asked many times before
 3. HR responds to the email with the necessary information



- Scenario 2: Searching for answers to a simple question
 1. Employee has a simple question
 2. Employee searches through a 19-page policy document
 3. Finds the single sentence that answers their question
- Scenario 3: Seeking answers informally
 1. Employee has a question
 2. Employee reaches out to teammates for an informal answer

Pain Point and Bottlenecks

According to Thomas T (2026), some identified issues are as follows:

- HR answering questions that have been asked many times before, they could be spending more time on other work.
- Answering risk-bearing questions informally can lead to risks, potentially risking compliance if answered inaccurately; “Creating an unofficial version of the policy”
- Even if an employee locates the right document, they would have to look through pages to locate an answer—they may give up and email HR instead. To them, this solution is easier, but not for the HR
- Questions may touch upon different documents, a simple document search may not lead to an answer.

Current uses of AI chatbots / FAQ tools answering policy questions

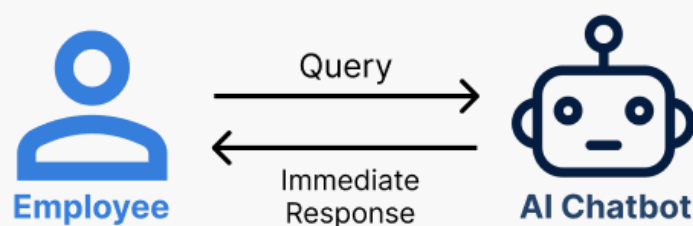
Here, we look at how AI is currently facilitating the HR process through some examples.

Example 1: IBM AskHR

- IBM's virtual agent that "automates more than 80 HR tasks and handle over 2.1 million employee conversations annually"
- Lightens the burden of increased complexity, inconsistent policies, heavy reliance on manual, repetitive task
 - This includes answering policy questions.

EXAMPLE 2: OptiHR

- A conversational AI assistant built by Optimus Information
- "Lives entirely within Microsoft Teams", built using Microsoft Copilot Studio and Power Automate
- Allows employees to ask HR questions and get instant answers based on company policies, submit leave applications in a short time, and generate/route IT or Admin support tickets.
- Saved 8-10 hours per month of HR team effort, reduced employee effort by 70-80% for common HR and IT/Admin tasks, and so on



Same day process, no need to wait for an answer
HR does not have to respond to repeated queries

References

Blog. (2026, April 16). *AI in HR: Top 5 use cases and benefits* | Zendesk Australia.

Zendesk. <https://www.zendesk.com/au/blog/ai/workflow-automation/ai-in-hr/#georedirect>

Thomas, T. (2026). *PolicyCentral.Ai. The Questions Employees Keep Asking HR, and Why AI Policy Search Finally Answers Them* | PolicyCentral.ai.

<https://www.policycentral.ai/blogs/hr-policy-management/ai-policy-search-questions-employees-ask-hr/>

Ibm.com. (2025). *Transforming HR support with agentic AI*. [online]

<https://www.ibm.com/case-studies/ibm-askhr>

Optimus Information (2026). *Microsoft Azure & AI Consulting in Canada* | Optimus

Information. [online] Optimus Information. Available at: <https://optimusinfo.com/case-studies/optihr>

Paradox.ai. (2026). *Reducing time to hire By 75% with conversational AI*. [online]

Available at: <https://www.paradox.ai/case-studies/chipotle>